



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Lao People's Democratic Republic. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.
What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing that! It's great that you're thinking ahead about your future. Since you've just finished primary school in Denmark (which ends after **9th grade**, or **10th if you chose the optional year**), your next step usually involves choosing between a few common paths in the Danish education system. Here's a breakdown tailored to your situation:

Your Options After Primary School in Denmark:

1. General Upper Secondary Education (Gymnasiale Uddannelser)

This path prepares you for university or other higher education. Choose this if you enjoy academic subjects and want more options in the future.

- **STX (Studentereksamen)** – Broad focus (languages, humanities, science, social science)
- **HHX (Higher Commercial Examination)** – Focus on business, economics, international trade
- **HTX (Higher Technical Examination)** – Focus on science, technology, IT
- **HF (Higher Preparatory Exam)** – Shorter (2 years), more direct route to some higher education programs

✓ *Recommended if you enjoy school, want to go to university, or want a professional career.*

2. Vocational Education and Training (EUD)

You combine school and paid apprenticeships in a company. After this, you can work as a skilled worker or continue to a **higher vocational education** (EUX).

- Jobs include: Electrician, carpenter, hairdresser, chef, mechanic, etc.
- You earn money during training.
- EUX is a combination of EUD and upper secondary education – gives you both a trade and the option to continue studying later.

✓ *Recommended if you want to start working earlier or prefer hands-on learning.*

3. 10th Grade (Optional)

If you're unsure or want to improve your academic or social skills before choosing a direction, 10th grade (efterskole or regular) can give you a year to grow, reflect, and prepare.

✓ *Recommended if you're unsure what to do next or want to mature a bit before upper secondary or vocational education.*

How to Decide?

Here are a few questions to help:

- Do you enjoy academic subjects like math, history, languages? → **Consider STX, HTX, HHX**
- Are you more hands-on, practical, and eager to start working? → **Consider EUD or EUX**
- Want to run a business or work in international trade someday? → **HHX**
- Like working with technology or science? → **HTX**
- Interested in getting work experience but still keeping the door open for university? → **EUX**
- Not sure at all yet? → **Consider 10th grade or an efterskole to explore your interests**

Personal Factors You Might Consider

- **Cultural background:** Your Lao heritage might give you a unique perspective in fields like international relations, intercultural communication, or business.
- **Language skills:** Being fluent in Danish and potentially Lao (or other languages) can be a big asset.
- **Long-term dreams:** Want to be a doctor, engineer, teacher, chef, or start your own business? That can guide your choice.

My Recommendation (based on what you've shared):

If you're open to studying and want to keep your options open, **STX** or **HTX** would be strong choices. They prepare you for university and a wide range of careers. If you prefer practical work but still want the option to study later, **EUX** is a very smart route — a mix of vocational and academic education.

Would you like help exploring a specific path like HTX or EUX? Or do you want help picking based on your interests and strengths?